TRUSTMRR DATASET ANALYSIS · SESSION 3

# Beyond the Hype: What 1,000 Startups' Revenue Really Tells Us

*A category-level inference study on trailing revenue windows, growth momentum, and monetization efficiency*

**1,000**

startups tracked

**19**

categories analyzed

**4**

trailing revenue windows

Source: TrustMRR public revenue index · Frozen 30 Jul 2026

# The Dataset & How We Read It

*29 fields per startup - revenue, audience, pricing, category, and marketplace signals*

1

### 1,000 startups, 19 usable categories

726 of 1,000 startups carry a category tag; this analysis keeps the 19 categories with 10+ startups (672 companies) so averages aren't skewed by one-off entries.

2

### Four trailing revenue windows

Each startup reports cumulative revenue for the trailing 30 days, 3 months, 12 months, and all-time - not sequential monthly buckets.

3

### Built for comparison, not vanity totals

Raw totals reward category size. We normalize every window to a monthly rate before comparing categories.

OUR TWO GROWTH SIGNALS

## Momentum

Last-30-day revenue ÷ average monthly revenue over the last 3 months.

> 1.0 → this month is running hotter than the recent quarter

## Trend

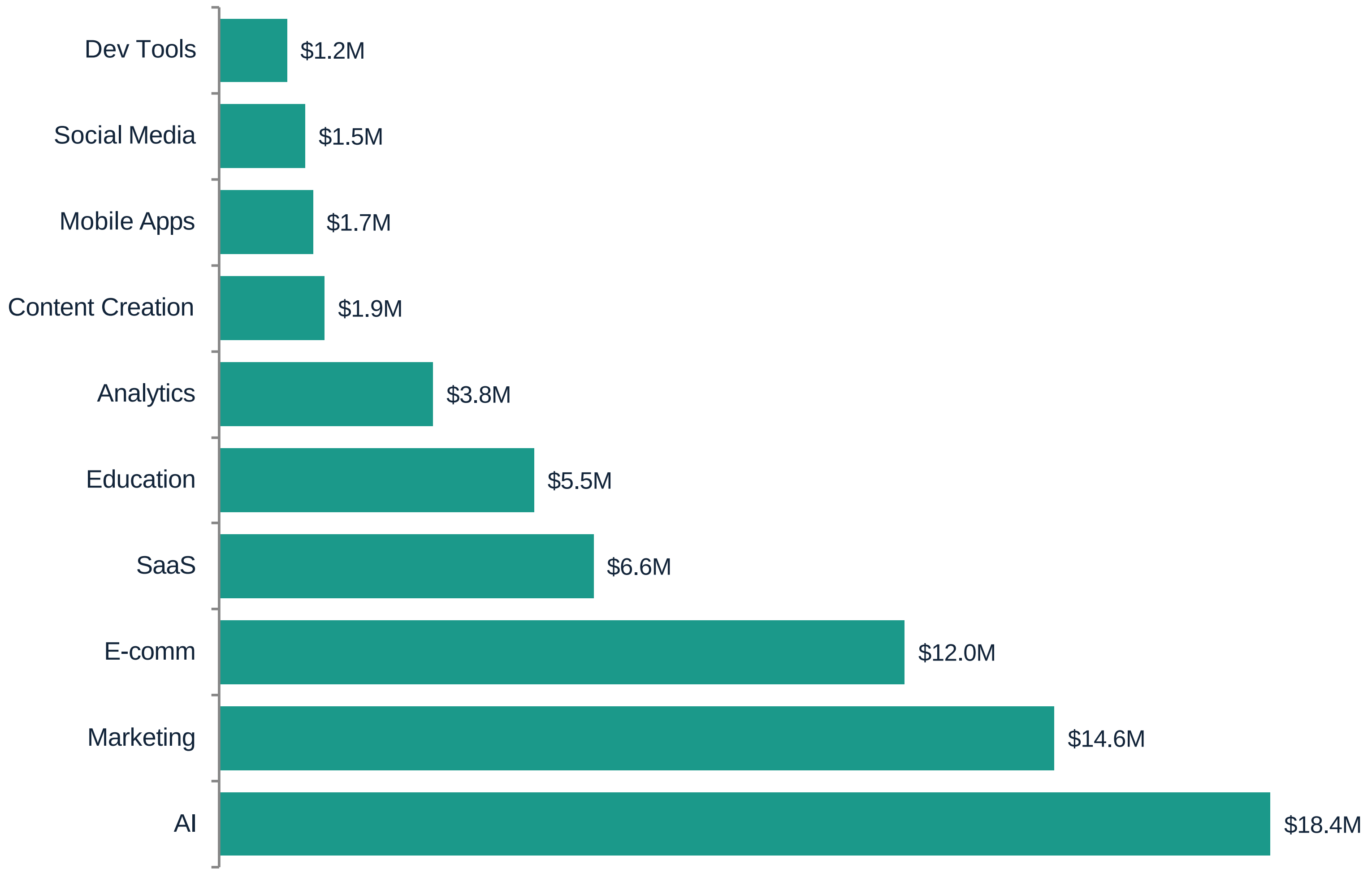
Average monthly revenue over the last 3 months ÷ average monthly revenue over the last 12 months.

> 1.0 → the category is compounding over the full year

*Together they separate a category that's genuinely accelerating from one that's coasting on old wins.*

# Revenue Is Extremely Concentrated

*Trailing 12-month revenue by category, across 672 categorized startups*




**63%**

**of all tracked revenue comes from just 3 categories**

*AI · Marketing · E-commerce*

AI alone accounts for 25.8% of tracked revenue with more than triple the startup count (197) of any other category - scale and popularity are moving together.

# AI Isn't Just Big - It's Compounding

*The category leads on every window, and is still accelerating on top of that lead*

**$18.4M**
trailing 12-month revenue

**197**
AI startups tracked

**1.12x**
momentum (30d vs 3m avg)

**1.37x**
trend (3m avg vs 12m avg)

## Spotlight: the AI startups driving it

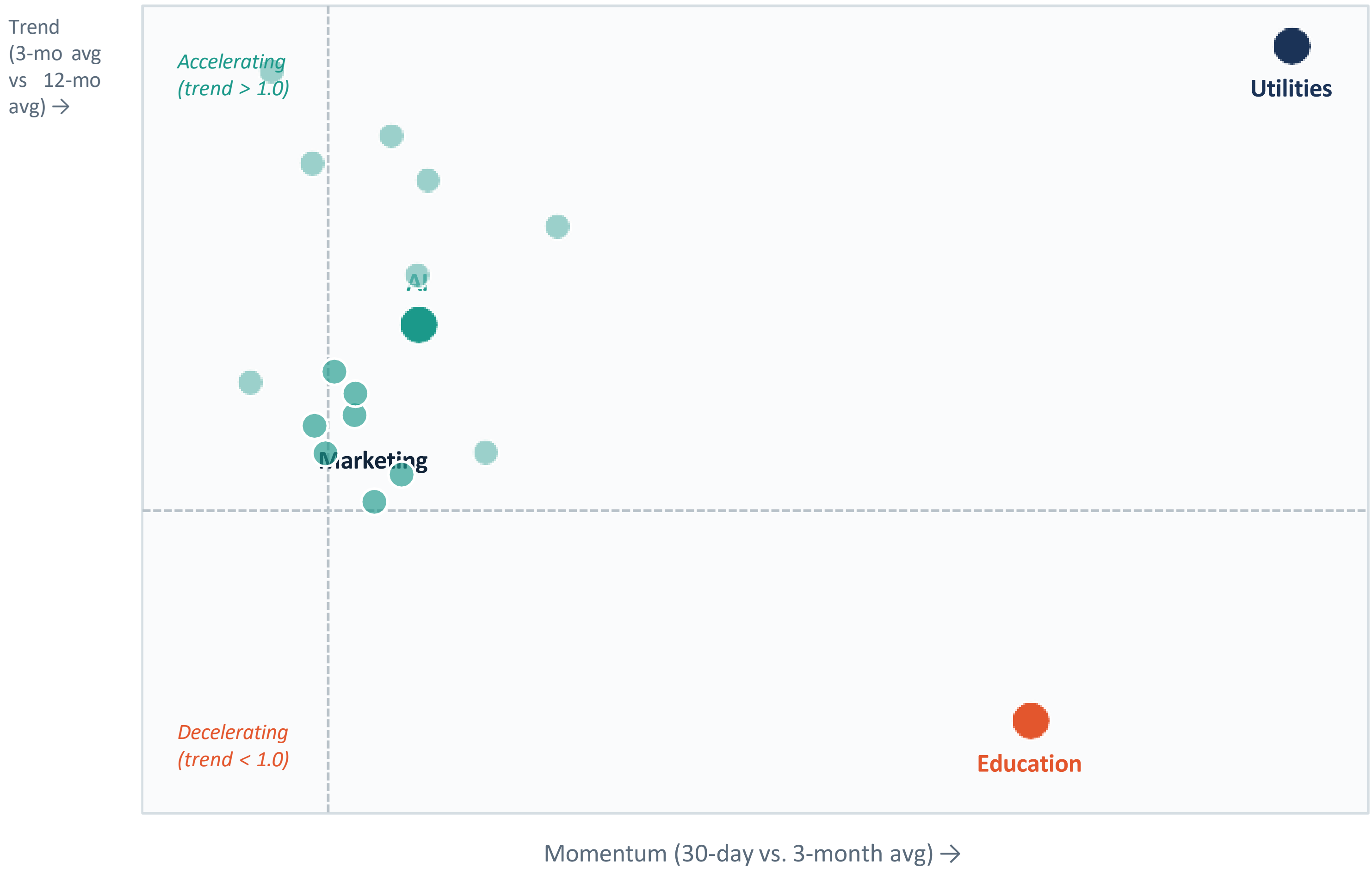
| STARTUP | 12-MONTH REVENUE | LAST 30 DAYS |
|---|---|---|
| **Comp AI** | $3.94M | $575K |
| **Rezi** | $2.98M | $242K |
| **GojiberryAI** | $1.54M | $386K |

### Why this matters

A category can lead on total revenue purely by having more startups. AI leads on total revenue AND on both growth ratios - its lead is widening, not just large.

# Almost Every Category Is Accelerating - Education Is the Exception

*Momentum (recent 30 days) vs. Trend (recent quarter vs. full year), by category*




EDUCATION

## Trend = 0.58x

the only category among the top 18 where the recent quarter's monthly average sits below the full year's - revenue is cooling on a 12-month view.

## Momentum = 1.95x

but the very last 30 days spiked well above that cooling average - a volatile, uneven recovery rather than steady growth. See next slide.

# Inside Education: A Few Early Winners Are Cooling Off

*Top Education startups by trailing 12-month revenue*

| STARTUP | 12-MONTH REV. | 3-MONTH REV. | 30-DAY REV. | 30d GROWTH |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Kibu** | $1.85M | $0 | $200K | -25.6% |
| **DataExpert / TechCreator** | $1.47M | $226K | $82K | -4.0% |
| **Codédex** | $844K | $233K | $77K | +0.4% |
| **Lunchbreak** | $557K | $106K | $31K | -8.9% |
| **MagicSlides.app** | $215K | $35K | $10K | -15.5% |

**Read:** Kibu and DataExpert together hold ~60% of the category's 12-month revenue but both show negative 30-day growth. Education's overall “recent spike” (previous slide) is smaller, less-established startups picking up share while the early leaders decelerate - a hand-off, not broad-based strength.

# Traffic Doesn't Convert to Revenue Equally

*Average revenue earned per visitor in the last 30 days, by category (categories with 3+ reporting startups)*


*AI monetizes visitors ~90x more efficiently than Education and ~44x more than E-commerce - its lead isn't just about traffic volume, it's about converting that traffic into paid revenue.*

# Takeaways

1

## Winners keep winning

AI leads on total revenue, momentum, trend, and monetization efficiency at once - its advantage is compounding, not plateauing.

2

## Watch cooling leaders, not just hot categories

Education looks healthy in aggregate 12-month revenue, but its two biggest startups (Kibu, DataExpert) are already shrinking month-over-month.

3

## Concentration is the norm

Just 3 of 19 categories generate 63% of tracked revenue - category choice matters as much as execution.

4

## Revenue per visitor is a hidden differentiator

Two categories with similar traffic can produce wildly different revenue; monetization model matters more than raw audience size.

*Limitations: only 726/1,000 startups carry a category tag; "revenue per visitor" relies on self-reported traffic present for just 178 startups; trailing windows can shift sharply from single large contracts (e.g., Kibu's $0 three-month figure against a $1.85M twelve-month figure).*

# Thank You

Data source: TrustMRR revenue index (1,000 startups) · Frozen 30 Jul 2026